

EXPERIENCE LABS · 2026

Reflection & Self-Assessment

Digital Marketing & Digital Skills Development

PREPARED BY

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Reflecting on growth through Experience Labs.

This presentation reflects on my growth throughout the Experience Labs programme with a stronger focus on digital marketing, online branding, freelancing, and digital business development.

Digital marketing research

Portfolio website development

Freelance preparation

Online branding activities

Proposal writing

Client-focused communication

Professional Skills · Part 1

Communication

8/10

Clear, professional emails and proposals. Evidence: client-facing freelance proposals on Upwork.

Creativity

8/10

Designed personal brand identity and portfolio visuals. Evidence: luyandandaba.com layout & content.

Adaptability

8/10

Switched smoothly between dev, design and marketing tasks each week.

Time Management

6/10

Met most deadlines but still optimising deep-work blocks. Evidence: weekly reflection log.

Problem Solving

8/10

Resolved hosting & domain setup issues independently using research and AI tools.

Professional Skills · Part 2

Self-Motivation

9/10



Consistently completed extra learning beyond required tasks.

Initiative

9/10



Proactively researched freelance gigs and pitched services.

Professionalism

7/10



Strong written tone; refining live-meeting presence.

Critical Thinking

7/10



Evaluating campaign ideas with clearer reasoning each week.

Resilience

8/10



Bounced back from rejected proposals and iterated on pitches.

Technical Skills · Part 1

Digital Marketing

8/10

Researched funnels, branding and content strategies for SMEs.

Content Creation

7/10

Producing portfolio posts, captions and short-form copy.

SEO Basics

6/10

Comfortable with on-page basics; growing in keyword strategy.

Social Media Branding

7/10

Refined personal brand voice across LinkedIn and X.

Website Management

7/10

Maintaining and updating luyandandaba.com regularly.

Technical Skills · Part 2

HTML / CSS

7/10

Building and customising responsive site sections.

Research & Analytics

8/10

Strong at digital research and synthesis of insights.

Online Freelancing Platforms

7/10

Active Upwork profile, proposals and portfolio links.

Figma Interpretation

6/10

Translating designs into working layouts; improving accuracy.

AI Productivity Tools

8/10

Daily use of AI assistants for writing, ideation and code.

Proof of progress in public.



Portfolio website

Built & deployed
luyandandaba.com



Marketing research

Mapped freelance & agency opps



Freelance proposals

Drafted & sent on Upwork



Personal branding

Refined voice & visual identity



Hosting & domain

Configured DNS, SSL, custom
domain



Site customization

Iterative content & UI updates



Research & reflections

Weekly insight write-ups



Upwork preparation

Profile, niche & job pipeline

Where I want to grow next.

TECHNICAL SKILL GAPS

- Advanced SEO
- Paid Advertising
- Marketing Analytics
- Email Marketing
- Advanced Content Strategy

PROFESSIONAL SKILL GAPS

- Networking
- Client Negotiation
- Public Speaking
- Confidence in Pricing Services

Ready, not-yet-ready, and what I need.

PREPARED FOR

- Researching digital marketing opportunities
- Building & maintaining a portfolio site
- Writing professional emails & proposals
- Using AI tools to boost productivity

UNPREPARED FOR

- Running paid ad campaigns at scale
- Negotiating high-value client contracts
- Live presenting to large audiences
- Setting & defending premium pricing

SUPPORT I NEED

- Mentorship from working marketers
- Hands-on paid-ads / analytics training
- Public speaking & pitch coaching
- Network of freelance peers

Compounding progress, week by week.

Self-rated capability over the programme



1

Stronger understanding of digital marketing

2

Improved confidence using digital tools

3

Better professional communication

4

Increased knowledge of freelancing platforms

5

Improved online branding awareness

6

Greater independence in learning & problem-solving

Roadmap from here.

SHORT-TERM

Next 6 months

- Improve SEO knowledge
- Learn Google Ads & Meta Ads
- Build a stronger online portfolio
- Land freelance digital marketing clients
- Improve content creation skills

LONG-TERM

1–3 years

- Become a digital marketing specialist
- Build a digital solutions business
- Work with international clients
- Master branding & campaign management
- Combine web dev + digital marketing services

Built for what's next.

The Experience Labs programme helped me develop both technical and professional skills relevant to digital marketing and freelancing.

Online branding

Digital business opportunities

Freelancing

Website management

Professional communication

Thank you. · Let's build something great.

Luyanda Ndaba · luyandandaba.com · 08 May 2026